A Short Guide to Slow Travel

Planning, trains, food and the way home

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Planning the journey

Every slow journey begins with a decision to leave something out. Fewer connections, fewer bookings and fewer bags make room for the things that happen between stations.

Choose a start and an end, then let the middle stay loose. A good route has one fixed point a day and a long afternoon with nothing in it.

Packing light

Carry what you can lift with one hand while you drink tea with the other. A change of clothes, a notebook, a paper map and a spare charger cover almost every journey.

Pack the night before and leave a quarter of the bag empty for what you collect on the way.

Getting around

Trains are the heart of a slow journey. Windows that open, a dining car that serves tea, and a timetable that rewards patience.

Buses fill the gaps between the lines, and ferries tie the coast together. Ask at each station which way the locals go; the answer is rarely the one the app gives.

Trains

Book the night train when the distance is long. You trade a hotel bill for a narrow bed and wake up somewhere new. Take a window seat, an early dinner and a book you will not fin

Day trains are for watching. Sit facing forward and let the landscape do the talking.

Eating well

Eat where the menu is short and the room is full. Order what the next table is having.

Breakfast is the meal that tells you most about a place. Find the bakery with the queue and the cafe where nobody looks at a phone.

Markets

A market is the quickest way to learn a town. Walk a full lap before you buy anything, then go back for the stall that smelled best. Carry cash and small change.

Buy bread, cheese and fruit for the next train. A picnic on a night train beats any menu.

Coming home

The last day of a journey should be quiet. Walk the streets you walked on the first morning and notice what has changed, which is mostly you.

Write down three things you want to keep. Then plan the next journey before the bags are unpacked.

Safe travels.

More notes on slow travel:

https://example.com/slow-travel